



The 2x to 10x Checklist

*The Executive Diagnostic for Identifying the Leadership, Governance, and Adoption Gaps
Limiting your AI Transformation at 2x instead of 10x*

A research-backed guide for leaders building AI-native organizations

WHAT THIS GUIDE IS ABOUT?

Every company has the same AI tools now.

Some scale fast.

Others stay stuck at 2x gains when 10x was always possible.

The difference is never the technology. It's the leadership, governance, and adoption gaps nobody has named yet.

This checklist names 10 of them, across leadership alignment, operations, and organizational readiness, so you find your gap before it costs another quarter.

Built for: C-suite execs/Leaders who are past "we bought the tools" and need to know **why ROI still isn't showing up** on the board deck.

The 2x to 10x checklist was designed to help leaders identify the specific gaps limiting their organization's ability to scale AI successfully.



HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read each mistake slowly. Be honest about which ones you recognise.

Most leaders spot three immediately. Some spot more.

The ones who act on what they find are the ones who close the gap between where they are and where their organization is capable of going.

MISTAKE 1 OF 10

Measuring people by the effort they put in - not the impact they create

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Every role moves something from before to after. A sales rep moves a stranger to a buyer. A manager moves a team from unsure to aligned. That move is the job, not the hours spent getting there.

AI keeps shrinking the effort needed. Reward effort, and every gain from AI starts to feel like a loss in worth.

Reflect:

- *Are we measuring our people by what impact they created - or by how hard they worked to create it?*
- *What gets praised more often in our organization: effort, activity, or outcomes?*
- *If I reviewed our performance metrics today, how many actually measure business impact versus visible work?*

MISTAKE 2 OF 10

No clear AI strategy tied to business goals

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

AI projects differ in risk and speed. Each one serves a different goal.

Without a clear priority, every project fights for the same budget.

And you end up with a busy AI portfolio you can't really defend to your board.

Reflect:

- *If I asked three leaders to explain our AI priorities, would I get the same answer?*
- *Which AI initiatives would we stop immediately if we were forced to cut the budget by 50%?*
- *Can every AI project be linked to a measurable business outcome—or are some simply "interesting to explore"?*

Managing the process - instead of managing the outcome

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Most companies are built to manage processes.

That means steps, approvals and checklists; And that worked when humans needed those steps.

AI doesn't have the same limits. Manage the process now, and you're protecting steps that no longer need to exist.

Reflect:

- *How often do our leadership meetings focus on activity updates rather than business results?*
- *If a team achieved the same outcome in half the time using AI, would our systems reward them or penalize them?*
- *Are we measuring progress- or merely tracking motion?*

PILLAR 2 OF 3 - OPERATIONAL EFFECTIVENESS

The infrastructure that lets AI scale - or stops it from ever getting there

Automating Tasks Instead of Redesigning Work

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Automating a task makes it faster. It doesn't make it better.

Real AI value comes from rethinking how work flows, not from speeding up a broken process.

The goal is not simply to do the same work faster. *The goal is to create a better way of working altogether.*

Reflect:

- *Are we using AI to make existing processes faster - or are we rethinking how work should happen altogether?*
- *If we were building this workflow from scratch today, would we really design it the same way?*
- *Where are we applying AI to inefficient processes instead of eliminating the inefficiency itself?*

MISTAKE 5 OF 10

Treating AI as a Tool, Instead of a Business Capability

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Tools come and go. A capability stays and compounds.

Treat AI as a tool, and adoption depends on who feels like using it.

Treat it as a capability, and it becomes part of how your company runs.

Reflect:

- *If employees lost access to their AI tools tomorrow, what capabilities would disappear with them?*
- *Have we clearly defined how AI contributes to competitive advantage within our organization?*
- *Are we investing in long-term capability building - or short-term experimentation?*

MISTAKE 6 OF 10

Letting AI reach customers before governance is in place

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

More AI use means more risk. Without governance, every team sets its own rules.

Wait for a problem to build guardrails, and you're reacting to risk you could have prevented in the first place.

Ask yourself:

- *As AI adoption grows, are our oversight mechanisms growing with it?*
- *Who is ultimately accountable for AI-related decisions, risks, and outcomes across the organization?*
- *If an AI-generated decision caused reputational, legal, or operational harm tomorrow, would we know exactly how to respond?*

PILLAR 3 OF 3 - ORGANIZATIONAL READINESS

The human layer that determines how far and how fast AI transformation happens

MISTAKE 7 OF 10

Automating the work where trust is the actual product

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Some work creates information. Other work creates trust.

AI wins at the first. It can't replace the second.

Cut human contact in the wrong place, and costs drop while relationships go cold.

The fix isn't AI or people. It's knowing where each one builds value.

Far fewer know where it should not.

Reflection:

- *Where in our workflow have we removed human contact that was actually building trust?*
 - *If we automated this process completely, what part of the customer, employee, or partner experience would become weaker?*
 - *Where in our organization is trust actually being built, and are we intentionally protecting those moments?*
-

Expecting Adoption Without Enablement

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Giving people AI access isn't the same as giving them AI skills.

Without training and best practices, adoption stays shallow and tools sit unused.

Reflect on:

- *How confident would the average employee rate their ability to use AI effectively today?*
- *Have we provided ongoing support, training, and guidance - or simply introduced new tools?*
- *Are our teams equipped to identify and create AI opportunities on their own?*

No Clear Ownership for AI Outcomes

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

AI projects touch many teams. That makes ownership easy to lose.

No owner means no one is responsible when results fall short.

Ask yourself:

- *Who is accountable for the business outcomes generated by AI initiatives?*
 - *Can every major AI project be traced to a specific owner with decision-making authority?*
 - *Are we assigning responsibility, or simply expecting collective accountability?*
-

Treating AI as a Project Instead of an Ongoing Transformation

WHY THIS MISTAKE MATTERS

Many organizations approach AI as a temporary initiative with a defined beginning and end.

The most successful organizations recognize that AI is fundamentally changing how work is performed, decisions are made, and value is created.

A project ends. Transformation doesn't.

Treat AI like a project, and you lose momentum the moment it's "done."

Treat it as ongoing, and you keep building an edge.

Ask yourself:

- *Are we approaching AI as a one-time implementation or as an evolving organizational capability?*
- *Where do we expect our AI maturity to be in two years, and what actions are supporting that vision today?*
- *Once initial projects are complete, what mechanisms ensure continued progress and innovation?*

THE REFRAME THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

Work is not a to-do list.

Work is a transformation.

A sales rep moves a stranger to a buyer.

An analyst moves raw data to a decision a leader can act on.

A manager moves a team from unsure to aligned.

That move is the job.

Tasks are just how you get there.

AI keeps shrinking the effort that move takes.

Most leaders are still managing effort, so every gain from AI feels like a threat instead of a win.

The leaders hitting 10x ask one question their competitors never do →

"What's the fastest path to the transformation, and what mix of people and AI gets us there?"

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

If you saw your company in even one of these 10 mistakes, you found something real.

Here's what closing it looks like:

AI running quietly in the background while you focus on what's next.

A team that trusts the tools enough to actually use them.

A board that asks what you're building next, instead of what happened to the ROI.



And that's not far off. It's one gap away.

The leaders who get there first didn't have better AI. They found their gap and closed it before anyone else did.

You just found yours.

Let's close it → [Book your 2x to 10x Strategy Call](#)

Pan Seth

Helping leaders navigate one of the most important transformations of their careers.

Founder, The Forward Org | AI Strategy, Leadership & Transformation